

Chapter 30-5 Translation

After a long while, when Xu Qingzhu had sorted through her thoughts, she said to Zhao Xuning: "Do you remember what I told you about the first time I met Liang Shi when I was five years old?"

Zhao Xuning nodded, "That was when you were kidnapped, and you and Liang Shi escaped together. After Liang Shi returned, she was abnormal for a period of time, but no one really paid attention."

Especially herself—she hadn't cared at all.

She just thought Liang Shi had gone crazy.

Back then, she had even been a little happy about it.

Xu Qingzhu said: "That year I was five, Liang Shi was seven. When we were kidnapped, she took care of me a lot. She even roasted sweet potatoes for me in the wilderness and encouraged me to live well, saying that life would definitely get better because we would definitely have lots of love."

Zhao Xuning listened quietly to her story.

And Xu Qingzhu became immersed in those memories, her cool voice carrying a hint of tenderness.

"At that time, I thought this older sister was very strange. We were clearly being bullied so terribly—those people whipped us with whips, slapped our faces, and grabbed our hair to bang our heads against the ground, creating one bloody mark after another. One child was killed just like that, bleeding so much."

When she said this, Xu Qingzhu's voice was trembling.

Obviously, she was remembering the tragic scene from that year, but she was restraining her emotions.

This was the first time she had mentioned the details of the kidnapping case to anyone other than her attending physician.

Zhao Xuning clearly noticed her abnormal state and frowned, reminding her gently: "If you feel uncomfortable, you don't have to say it. Otherwise, later you might..."

"It's okay, I can control myself." Xu Qingzhu took a light breath and continued from where she left off: "I also saw with my own eyes a child's finger being chopped off and then thrown to feed the big wolfhounds. And because Liang Shi often smiled, the kidnappers found her displeasing, slapped her, and directly knocked out one of her front teeth."

Listening to this, Zhao Xuning felt angry in her heart.

Perhaps because Liang Shi was usually too arrogant and domineering, she couldn't connect her with the kidnapping case from back then, and couldn't empathize with the pain she had suffered. But hearing Xu Qingzhu say this now, Zhao Xuning suddenly remembered Liang Shi from that period.

That was when they had just met.

Zhao Xuning was a transfer student.

She was usually someone who paid no attention to outside affairs, so she didn't care what happened in the outside world.

She only knew there was a little girl in the class who had been kidnapped and often spoke nonsense after returning.

She hadn't taken it to heart at all.

But one day, the comic book she had placed on her desk was torn to pieces. She was very angry, and when she turned around, she saw the other half of her comic book on that little girl's desk.

And the little girl was still continuously tearing the paper into long strips.

Zhao Xuning went forward and got into a fight with the little girl.

That little girl was Liang Shi.

At that time, everyone said she was crazy.

Normal people had nothing to say to crazy people.

But from some point on, the crazy person started forming cliques and became arrogant and domineering.

Everyone thought there was nothing wrong with this.

Because crazy people were supposed to be arrogant and domineering.

Zhao Xuning tried to extract clues from her memory but found no trace.

She continued to listen to Xu Qingzhu.

"Even though this older sister was strange, I still felt she was very warm and kind. She had a beautiful smile, and I was willing to believe her." Xu Qingzhu said: "On our wedding day, I mentioned the childhood kidnapping to her, but she said nothing, as if she had never known me before."

"Also, ever since we met, her smile has always been sinister, nothing like the person I knew as a child. I comforted myself that we had both grown up, so we forgot, and people change. But recently..."

She paused, "I've started frequently seeing familiar smiles on her face, with the exact same curve as when she was little."

"So you suspect she's the person you saw as a child?" Zhao Xuning asked.

Xu Qingzhu shook her head, "I don't know."

Precisely because she couldn't judge, she was telling everything about the past in detail, hoping that Zhao Xuning, who was more rational, could help her judge.

"It's just my feeling," Xu Qingzhu said. "I inexplicably feel a sense of familiarity about her."

Zhao Xuning: "..."

"This is indeed difficult to handle," Zhao Xuning said. "I even tested her DNA—she is Liang Shi."

Both were science students with rational thinking, so they wouldn't believe things without scientific verification.

"Is there a possibility that she has multiple personalities?" Zhao Xuning said. "Can you tell me some other different things?"

Xu Qingzhu thought for a moment and told her everything about knowing Liang Shi after growing up, including all her moody moments.

She would occasionally treat Xu Qingzhu extremely well, taking her to high-end restaurants, sending her air-delivered roses, intimately calling her "wife," "baby," "sweetheart." But at the same time, she did the same with other women outside. She would constantly cheat, sometimes pretending, but sometimes not even bothering to pretend. The most excessive time was bringing a woman home, right in their newlywed bedroom.

That woman asked her, "Am I so much better than your Omega wife?"

She coaxed the other person with sweet words in bed.

At that time, Xu Qingzhu was standing outside and heard everything.

She endured it for four months.

Actually, she had never hoped that Liang Shi would change. She just felt that since it was a business marriage and the Liang family had given the Xu family so much money, allowing Minghui Jewelry to barely survive.

Then she would put up with it.

This was the first time she told Zhao Xuning about her married life. After hearing it, Zhao Xuning immediately clenched her fists: "Why didn't you say anything back then? She had already become such a bastard, and you were still covering for her?"

"Not really," Xu Qingzhu smiled bitterly. "I just felt there was no need to make you all sad along with me."

Zhao Xuning: "..."

Xu Qingzhu didn't dwell on this issue for too long and quickly changed the subject.

After hearing what she said, Zhao Xuning was silent for a long time and said somewhat uncertainly: "She might have multiple personalities, or triple personalities."

"Has she maintained this state ever since she woke up that day?" Zhao Xuning asked.

Xu Qingzhu nodded, "Yes."

"Logically speaking, multiple personality disorder is a long-term mental illness. The relationships between each personality are different. Some split a personality to protect themselves because of trauma, and some assign their accumulated negative emotions to another personality to avoid certain things. Currently, in medical research history, the most severe case of personality split reached 32 personalities. Mental illnesses all require specific analysis of specific problems, so I can't give you a definite answer. You might get a better answer by asking Dr. Gu."

Xu Qingzhu sighed heavily, "Life really likes to give me difficult problems."

"So you just forgive her like this?" Zhao Xuning asked. "I used to think she might just be wild in her playing, but..."

That was too wild.

In this circle, playing around outside was quite normal.

Especially when marrying someone from a mismatched background, it was common to keep several people outside while the wife at home turned a blind eye.

But like Liang Shi, who brought women home right after marriage and indulged herself while trampling on her wife's dignity—that was rare even in their circle.

Unless the two families had a generational feud.

But obviously, they didn't.

In fact, Liang Shi had actively pursued Xu Qingzhu back then.

"I haven't forgiven her," Xu Qingzhu shrugged. "Whatever attitude she has toward me, that's my attitude. I'm currently dependent on others¹, so if we can cooperate amicably, we'll cooperate. If not, I'll move out. You know my family's situation isn't ideal right now, and my parents definitely wouldn't agree to my divorce, so there's no need to have a falling out with her."

Zhao Xuning was dumbfounded. She was suddenly surprised: "Did you ever love her? It feels like you can just let go when you say so, without any sadness at all."

Xu Qingzhu: "..."

After a moment of silence, she calmly asked back: "Would you have feelings for someone who is extremely emotionally unstable, cheats right after marriage, and is constantly on the verge of domestic violence? Even if I once liked her before marriage, I gradually gave up after we got married."

Actually, she couldn't even say which specific moment made her stop liking her.

It might have been when Liang Shi went to sleep with other women on their wedding night, or when Liang Shi angrily overturned the dining table, throwing all the food on the floor and even wanting her to kneel on the broken plates. It could also have been when Liang Shi took away her phone, not allowing her to contact the outside world, trying to make her a canary² trapped in a cage.

But what finally broke through her inner defenses was when Liang Shi hid all the suppressants³ in the house during her heat cycle.

She didn't want to die.

This was the final bottom line.

All those things before—as long as she didn't have expectations of Liang Shi, they wouldn't cause her too much harm.

She would just live through this life peacefully.

After all, people don't necessarily need love.

For her, family affection and friendship were more important than romantic love.

She had once held hope for Liang Shi in certain moments, but Liang Shi had personally shattered all of that.

Perhaps because it was late at night, Xu Qingzhu was more open than usual when talking about these things.

She said: "I sometimes think about how wonderful it would have been if I hadn't married her back then."

"That way she would always remain beautiful in my memory, at least leaving me with some hope."

Footnotes

¹ 寄人籬下 (jì rén lí xià) - A Chinese idiom meaning "to live under someone else's roof" or "to be dependent on others." It describes the situation of living in someone else's house and being dependent on their charity or kindness, often implying a somewhat uncomfortable or vulnerable position.

² **金絲雀 (jīn sī què)** - "Golden canary" or simply "canary." In Chinese culture, this metaphor refers to a woman who is kept like a pet bird—beautiful, pampered, but trapped and unable to be independent. It's similar to the Western concept of a "kept woman" or "trophy wife."

³ **抑制劑 (yì zhì jì)** - In omegaverse⁴ fiction, these are suppressants that help Omegas control their heat cycles and related symptoms. Without them during a heat cycle, an Omega could be in serious physical distress or even life-threatening danger.

⁴ **Omegaverse** - A subgenre of fiction that features a world where people are divided into Alpha, Beta, and Omega secondary genders, each with specific biological and social characteristics. This story appears to be set in such a universe.